

Lede

A browser extension where journalists document sources as they work — so the newsroom keeps the source map, and readers can later ask it questions.

A sidebar that documents sources at the moment of publishing

1 Highlight

Journalist selects a passage in their own own byline.

2 Match + infer

AI matches against the repository and infers metadata from the passage.

3 Save snapshot

Tagged sources flow into the dashboard and dashboard and patterns surface across across stories.

The screenshot displays a web browser interface for 'THE HAITIAN TIMES' website. The main article is titled '‘Call your Senator,’ advocates urge community as push to pass TPS for Haitians continues' and is dated May 19, 2026. The sidebar on the right, titled 'Lede', contains a 'Highlight a passage' section with a text selection tool and a 'TAG A SOURCE' section. The article text includes a byline 'BY MACOLLVIE J. NEEL' and a date 'MAY. 19, 2026'. The sidebar also shows 'THIS STORY' and 'TAGGED FOR THIS STORY' sections.

May 22, 2026 | 9:17 AM

THE HAITIAN TIMES
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IMMIGRATION & MIGRATION

‘Call your Senator,’ advocates urge community as push to pass TPS for Haitians continues

Faith leaders, immigration advocates and lawmakers ramp up pressure to pass H.R. 1689, which would protect Haitian TPS through 2027

BY MACOLLVIE J. NEEL MAY. 19, 2026

Search ...

Lede

THIS STORY

Senate push grows to extend Haitian TPS through 2027

haitiantimes.com

TAG A SOURCE

Highlight a passage

Select text in the article that came from a specific source, then return here.

TAGGED FOR THIS STORY

No sources tagged yet.

The form factor was the problem, not the features.

v0 — STANDALONE WEB APP

26

named entities extracted from one one article — every name in the text, text, treated as a source.

Even with a polished metadata form, going through 26 cards was tedious. The wrong unit of capture.

v1 — BROWSER EXTENSION

4–6

sources the journalist actually used — captured by highlighting passages in the published article.

AI suggests metadata from the highlighted text. The journalist journalist confirms and reviews parser output. They don't fill don't fill out forms

Tools journalists actually use are part of the infrastructure or workflow. Standalone apps require commitment; ambient tools live alongside existing work.

Five questions, none fully solved — but each shaped the design.

1 Source consent doesn't transfer.

A source consented to one reporter, one story — not to becoming queryable infrastructure. Resolution: a required consent_boundary field; the reader-facing API physically cannot surface non-on-record sources.

2 The transparency dashboard can be weaponized.

"78% institutional sources" in bad-faith hands becomes "this newsroom is biased." Resolution: per-newsroom dashboards, reporter-to-self comparisons. Vetting standards stay with the newsroom that did the vetting.

3 AI inference of source type is a power claim.

The model decides whether someone is "institutional" or "an advocate." Resolution: AI suggests; the journalist confirms. Suggestions are visible and editable. The journalist owns the call and remains in-the-loop.

4 Demographic auto-tagging is technically possible. I deliberately didn't ship it.

The schema and editor forms accept manual demographic entry by a journalist who knows the source. The LLM is explicitly instructed never to infer race, gender, or ethnicity from a passage. The judgment stays with the journalist.

5 The future reader-facing tool risks reproducing the narrowness of its surfaces.

A context agent grounded only in journalist-vetted sources could amplify the same over-representation. Resolution: Stage 2 must show readers whose voices ground the answers, not just the answers.

From single-reporter prototype to public-discernment infrastructure.

NOW

vo + extension

Working prototype, tested tested against several newsrooms with a focus on on a Haitian Times beat.

JUN

Community
newsroom pilot

Per-newsroom repository scoping. Working alongside Haitian Times and 2-3 other newsroom reporters on real bylines.

SEP 2026

Newsroom
deployment

One newsroom partner. Live representation gap detection in the sidebar.

FALL 2026 →

Stage 2 +
research

Readers ask: 'What's been reported on Haitian TPS?' Answers grounded in journalists' vetted sources.

Stage 1 builds the only kind of grounding a context agent can responsibly draw on. The vetted repository is the foundation.